

Question:

A 34-year-old woman presents to her OB/GYN with complaints of missing her last 3 periods as well as intermittent spontaneous milky-white nipple discharge bilaterally for the past 3 months. Vital signs are stable and within normal limits. Neurologic examination is without abnormality, including normal visual fields. Serology and MRI of the brain are ordered, with results pending. Which of the following sets of laboratory results would be expected in this patient?

Answer Choices:

- A. Decreased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH
- B. Decreased prolactin, increased FSH, increased LH
- C. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, increased LH
- D. Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH

Reasoning + Answer:

<reasoning process here> The patient is a 34-year-old woman presenting with absent periods (oligomenorrhea) and bilateral spontaneous milky-white nipple discharge. These symptoms are classic for hyperprolactinemia, which can cause galactorrhea and menstrual disturbances. Hyperprolactinemia leads to increased prolactin levels, which suppresses the hypothalamic-pituitary axis, resulting in decreased secretion of follicle-stimulating hormone (FSH) and luteinizing hormone (LH) via negative feedback.

Therefore, the expected laboratory findings in this patient would include elevated prolactin levels and decreased FSH and LH.

This matches option D: Increased prolactin, decreased FSH, decreased LH.

Note: While option C also has increased prolactin and decreased FSH, it includes increased LH, which is inconsistent with the suppressive effect of high prolactin on the HPG axis. Prolactin suppresses both FSH and LH, so both should be decreased.

Thus, the correct answer is D.

</reasoning process here>

<answer>D</answer>

